

at the same restaurant. I wasn't with you last night, in Texas, or ten years ago. Whether you're comparing steaks, sculpture, weather, or cars, comparisons take *you* out of the here and now and offer *me* no insight. Do it often enough, and *you* lose touch with living day to day while *I* get frustrated.

The Three Cs may seem obvious, but they're quite hard to follow consistently. Trying is the key.

Another rule is:

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### **Learn the language**

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We first found out how silly it is to insist on speaking English when, the week we moved to Buenos Aires, we had dinner with an American couple there. "The people here are so dull," the wife told us. "They never do anything except play bridge in the American Club and drink scotch." Later on in the evening Vicki asked her how her Spanish was.

"You don't need to speak Spanish in Argentina," the wife assured us. "Except in the supermarket, the people here speak English."

Move to a foreign country, insist on speaking English, and you'll wind up at the American Club playing bridge and drinking scotch instead of living the adventure of a foreign post. I suppose if you're 60 you might find it hard to pick up a new language. Then again, you might not. But at age 35 or 40 you have no excuse.

Besides learning the local language, you should eat local food, tell local jokes, hire local help, take local trains or buses, and bet local horses. Live like Brazilians and you may wind up having as much fun as they do.

Take Berlitz or something similar before you leave home. Once you arrive, continue with one-on-one training and add group classes. Groups introduce you to other newcomers and can help ease you through the transition.

A final rule is:

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### **Go with the flow**

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